UNIT - 3

1. **Digital Marketing Planning and Setup**
2. Digital Marketing Operations Setup

Department of Mechanical Engineering

3	**Digital Marketing Planning and Setup** Understanding digital media planning terminology and stages, steps to creating marketing communications strategy, introduction to search marketing, display marketing, social media marketing. **Digital Marketing Operations Setup** Basics of lead generation and conversion marketing, website content development and management, elements of user experience, web usability and evaluation.	**08**

Understanding Digital Media Planning Terminology

The two key considerations for a media planner while selecting a particular media for any type of promotion include:

(a) Effectiveness of media channel: Media planner has to ascertain which media channels would be best for higher *reach* and *response*.

(b) ROI of communication/promotion on that media: The other key factor is the anticipated return on investment (RoI) from the media promotions. RoI depends on *cost*, *frequency,* and *revenue* potential of executed promotions.


• DELIVER THE RIGHT MESSAGE
• TO THE RIGHT PERSON
• AT THE RIGHT TIME

Understanding Digital Media Planning Terminology

(a) **Reach**: refers to the total number of potential audience exposed to media during the plan time period at least once. Reach does not take into account the total audience who actually see the promotion but it only gives an indication of the universe of people who can be reached with the media among the client's target audience segment. For example, for a media plan targeting two million men in the 25–39 age bracket, a reach of 50 means that 50 percent (1 million) of the target audience will be potentially exposed to some of the media vehicles in the media plan.

(b) **Response:** includes the actual audience who actually read, viewed, or made a web visit and performed an action which is related and is important for marketer's promotion.

(c) **Relevance/impact:** involves looking at the relevance or context of a particular promotion in relation to the media vehicles chosen.

(d) **Timing and scheduling**: relates to decisions taken by a firm for its specific set of products to determine the period for promotions run and the way they would be scheduled for maximum impact. A typical example is advertising wherein a media planner can choose from one of the following allocation strategies:

- **Continuous:** involves even exposures throughout a given period.
- **Concentration:** refers to taking a specific period and spending the entire budget.
- **Fighting:** refers to alternate periods of high and no advertising.
- **Pulsing:** involves low advertising all the year round and heavy advertising for peak periods

(e) **Cost:** includes the basis on which costs are calculated to communicate different types of promotions. Digital media is typically bought as cost per million impressions (CPMs).

(f) **Frequency:** It involves the number of times a particular promotion is exposed to a person during the media plan. Frequency can be multiple exposures across the same medium or single exposures across multiple media for the same individual.

(g) **Media plan RoI:** It refers to the overall RoI which a marketer would achieve based on the total amount spent on a particular media plan across all the media channels and promotions combined. This takes into account the revenue generated through final conversions, following the funnel stages from impressions to clicks to leads to purchases.

Media Planning Concepts and Application to Media Channels

Media planning revolves around choosing the right media platforms to deliver a brand’s message effectively. Key concepts like **Reach**, **Response**, **Cost**, and **Frequency** help guide these decisions. Let's break down each concept and apply it to three common media channels: **Newspaper**, **Broadcast Media**, and **Online (Web)**.

1. Reach

Definition: The total number of unique individuals exposed to a message within a specific time period.

Application:

- **Newspaper:** Typically offers a **local/regional audience**. Broadsheets have higher reach than niche publications.
- **Broadcast Media (TV/Radio):** Provides **mass reach**; ideal for targeting broad demographics. Prime-time slots enhance reach.
- **Online (Web):** Highly customizable reach based on targeted ads, SEO, and social media campaigns. Enables precise audience targeting.

2. Response

Definition: The measurable action taken by the audience after exposure, such as inquiries, clicks, or purchases.

Application:

- **Newspaper:** Response is usually slower; relies on coupons, QR codes, or call-to-action headlines.
- **Broadcast Media:** Hard to track directly, but toll-free numbers, website mentions, or hashtags can encourage response.
- **Online (Web):** Immediate and trackable through clicks, conversions, and engagement metrics.

3. Cost

Definition: The financial investment required to place the advertisement. Often measured in terms of **CPM (Cost Per Thousand Impressions)**.

Application:

- **Newspaper:** Relatively low cost for local ads; premium for larger ad sizes or prime pages (e.g., front page).
- **Broadcast Media:** High costs for prime-time slots or popular programs; radio is usually more affordable than TV.
- **Online (Web):** Flexible budget options with pay-per-click (PPC) or impression-based models.

4. Frequency

Definition: The number of times an individual is exposed to the message within a given period.

Application:

- **Newspaper:** Lower frequency since readers may skip ads. Requires repeated insertions for consistent impact.
- **Broadcast Media:** High frequency with repeated airings, especially effective in building brand recall.
- **Online (Web):** Highly adaptable; platforms like Facebook and Google offer frequency capping to balance exposure without overwhelming users.

Media Plan Concepts	Newspaper (Vehicle as Single Page)	Broadcasting (Vehicle as Single Program)	Online (Web) (Vehicle as Single Web Page)
Channel Effectiveness			
Reach	**Measured as circulation** (Average gross distribution unclaimed copes)	**Measured as target audience** (% of Target audience exposed to a media vehicle)	**Measured as total web audience** (Total of all audiences across web pages)
Response	**Measured as readership** (Circulation* % of homes receiving* read claims)	**Measured as viewership** (% of target audience who actually viewed the program)	**Measured as total web visits** (Audiences which visited any of the web pages in a period)
Promotion Effectiveness			
Cost	**Measured as price per column inch** (Per Page)	**Measured as cost of GRPs** (% Who Watched a Program)	**Measured as CPM** (Cost Per Million Impressions)
Frequency	**Measured as pass-along rate.** (One ad can be viewed by many people)	**Measured as multiple views per person.** (Does not double-count exposures)	**Measured as total impressions.** (Each multiple view counts as an impression)

GRP (Gross Rating Points) is a key metric in broadcast media planning that measures the total exposure of an advertisement across a target audience. It’s commonly used in **TV** and **radio** advertising.

CPM (Cost Per Million) Impressions tells you how much you’re spending to get **1 million views (impressions)** on your advertisement.

Key Digital Planning Concepts

(a) **Web visits:** A visit refers to a visitor's session on all the firm's product sites within a particular period of time. During the session, the user might view multiple pages but the overall session is counted as a single one.

(b) **Page visits:** Involves the number of people visiting a particular page of the firm's website. This could be the homepage or a landing page specifically created to channel pre-defined consumer actions across the funnel.

(c) **Unique visitors:** Refers to the number of unique individuals that visit a website within a specific timeframe. The two methods to track unique visitors include tracking cookies or unique IP addresses.

(d) **Impressions:** The most important concept for digital buying, impressions relate particularly to display ads placed on multiple webpages and are the sum total of responses from a web server to a page request from the user browser. Impressions are calculated as *Reach* * *Frequency (number of people reached (X) number of times they saw an ad across media vehicles)* and are measured in an automated fashion by designated servers. It should be noted that even in the same web session, if a user lands on a particular page twice, it would be counted as two impressions instead of one.

(e) **Page views:** The total number of unique pages viewed by a person in a particular session would be the page views for that session.

(f) **Clicks:** The opportunity for a user to download another file by clicking an advertisement, as recorded by the server. After impressions count, this is the next stage in the conversion funnel for advertising.

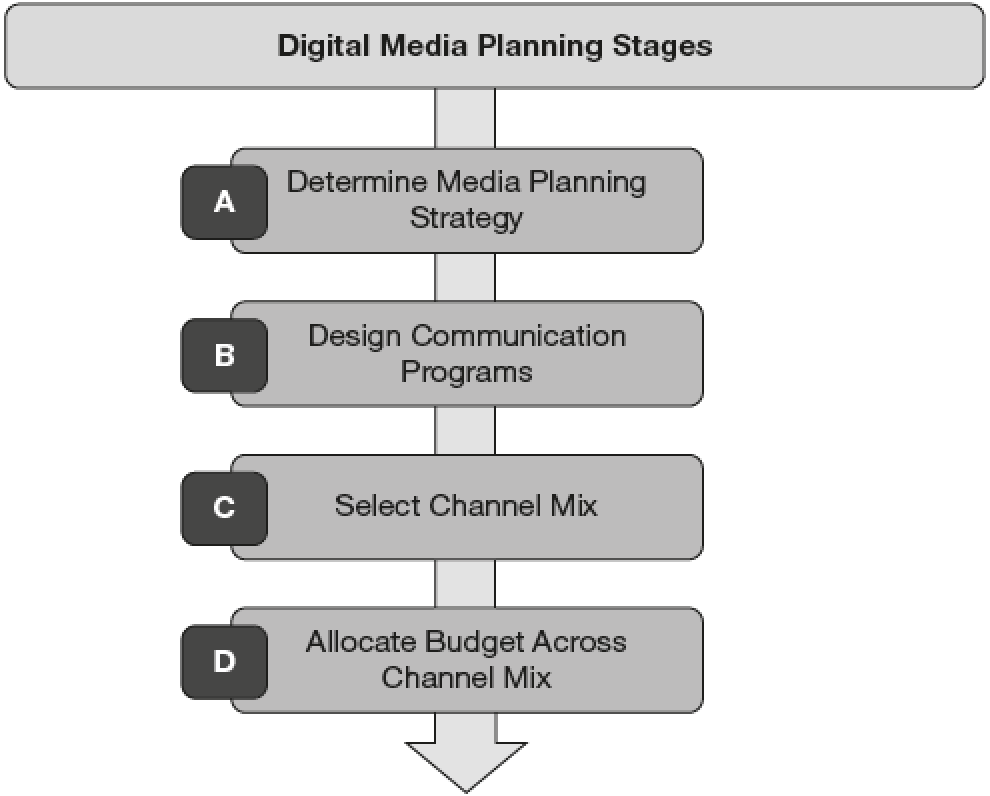
(g) **Click-through:** The action of following a link within an advertisement or editorial to another website or another page or frame within the website.

(h) **CPM (cost-per-thousand)**: Refers the cost of serving 1000 impressions. Almost all of the digital media buys are executed using this metric.

(i) **CPC (cost per click)**: Cost of advertising based on the number of clicks received.

(j) **CPA (cost per action)**: Cost of advertising based on a visitor taking a specifically designed action in response to an ad. Actions could include sales transaction, customer acquisition, or a click.

Digital Media Planning Stages

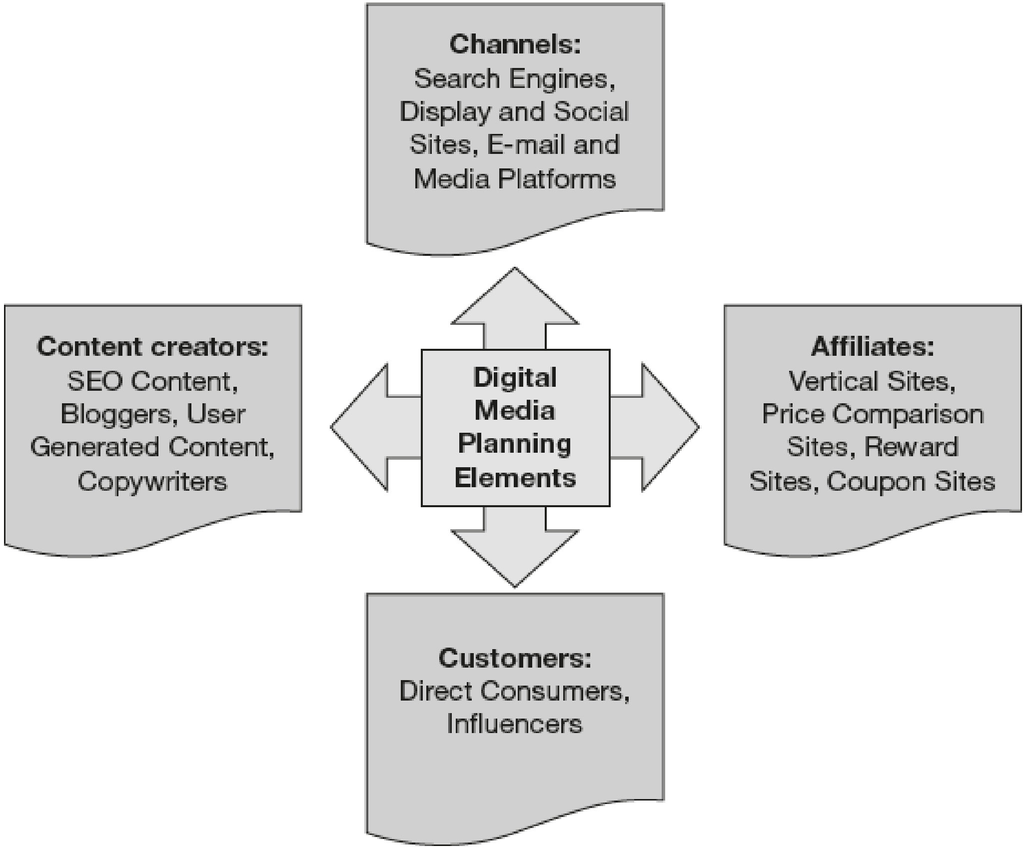


Determine the Media Planning Strategy

The first step towards creating a digital media plan is to determine what the brand wants to communicate and which channel mix is the best to promote given the budget allocation for the product portfolio and the timelines it has set to achieve its desired objects.

The best place for marketers to obtain information for their planning would come from the digital marketing roadmap (see Unit 2, section titled, 'Developing the Digital Marketing Strategy Roadmap'), which provides marketers with necessary research on the offering mix and its lifecycle stage, specified target audience, and their presence in the funnel along with the company's strategic intent.

Core Elements of Digital Media Planning



1. Channels

Where your content is delivered.

These are the platforms or media spaces used to promote your brand.

Examples: Social Media Platforms (Instagram, Facebook, LinkedIn)Search Engines (Google Ads, Bing)Email Marketing Platforms (Mailchimp, ConvertKit)Video Platforms (YouTube, TikTok)

Key Role: Selecting the right channel ensures your content reaches the intended audience effectively.

2. **Affiliates:** Partners who promote your brand or products. They earn a commission for driving traffic or sales through their referral links. **Examples:** Influencers sharing product links, Bloggers reviewing your smartphone and adding affiliate links, Coupon websites offering special deals. **Key Role:** Expands your reach through trusted promoters with established audiences.	3. **Content Creators :** People who produce engaging content for your brand. They create blogs, videos, social media posts, etc., to connect with your target audience. **Examples**: YouTubers creating unboxing videos, Writers crafting SEO-friendly blog posts, Graphic Designers developing creative ads. **Key Role**: Their storytelling and creativity shape audience perception.	4. **Customers:** The ultimate target of your marketing efforts. Understanding customer behavior, preferences, and demographics is crucial for success. **Examples:** Gen Z prefers short-form videos on Instagram or TikTok, Working professionals may respond better to LinkedIn ads or email campaigns **Key Role:** Customer insights guide your content, channel selection, and promotional strategies.

Design Communications Program

With an understanding of how digital media planning-mix strategy is created, the next stage is to decide the types of communications message to be designed for specific objectives of each product.

The two basic tasks of marketing communications are message creation and message dissemination.

We would cover this in detail in ‘Designing the Communication Mix,’

Select Channel Mix

The third stage of digital media planning involves selecting the digital channel mix most suited for a firm's product, depending upon which stage it is present in one of the 6S Digital Implementation stages.

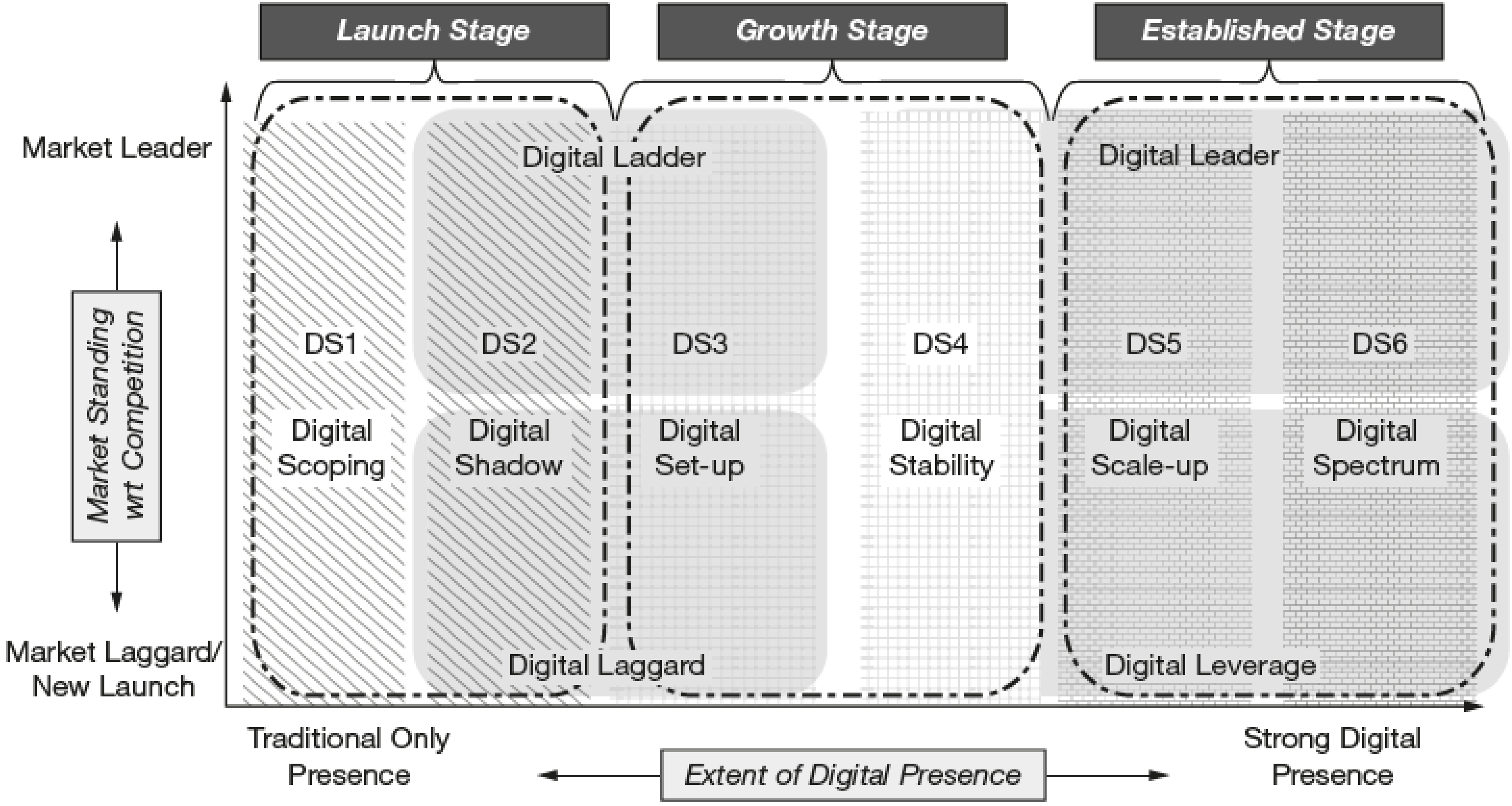


Figure 6.6 6S Digital Marketing Implementation Groups

In Fig. 6.6, the six stages of digital marketing implementation have been grouped into three buckets to chart their channel mix strategies (as the firm grows from digital scoping to digital spectrum stage) for the specific product at hand. This is explained below.

(a) **Launch stage:** Involves the firm (product) in its launch stage where it chooses specific media mix to generate awareness and initial enquiries.

(b) **Growth stage:** The firm (product) is already established and needs channels which would help convert prospects to confirmed leads to convert further into sales.

(c) **Established stage:** In this stage, the product is already stable and known and looks to guard its position and scale-up to become a leader across all possible channels.

Once the firm has grouped its product portfolio across the three group stages, it can look at mul
tiple channels across the promotional mix to decide on its final channel mix for execution. Th

1. **Promotion Outcome Type** – This refers to the desired impact of the promotion. It could be:

•**Brand Awareness** (e.g., social media, TV ads, influencer marketing)
•**Lead Generation** (e.g., PPC ads, SEO, content marketing)
•**Sales Conversion** (e.g., email marketing, retargeting ads, sales calls)

2. **Promotion Investment Type** – This relates to the financial and resource allocation, such as:

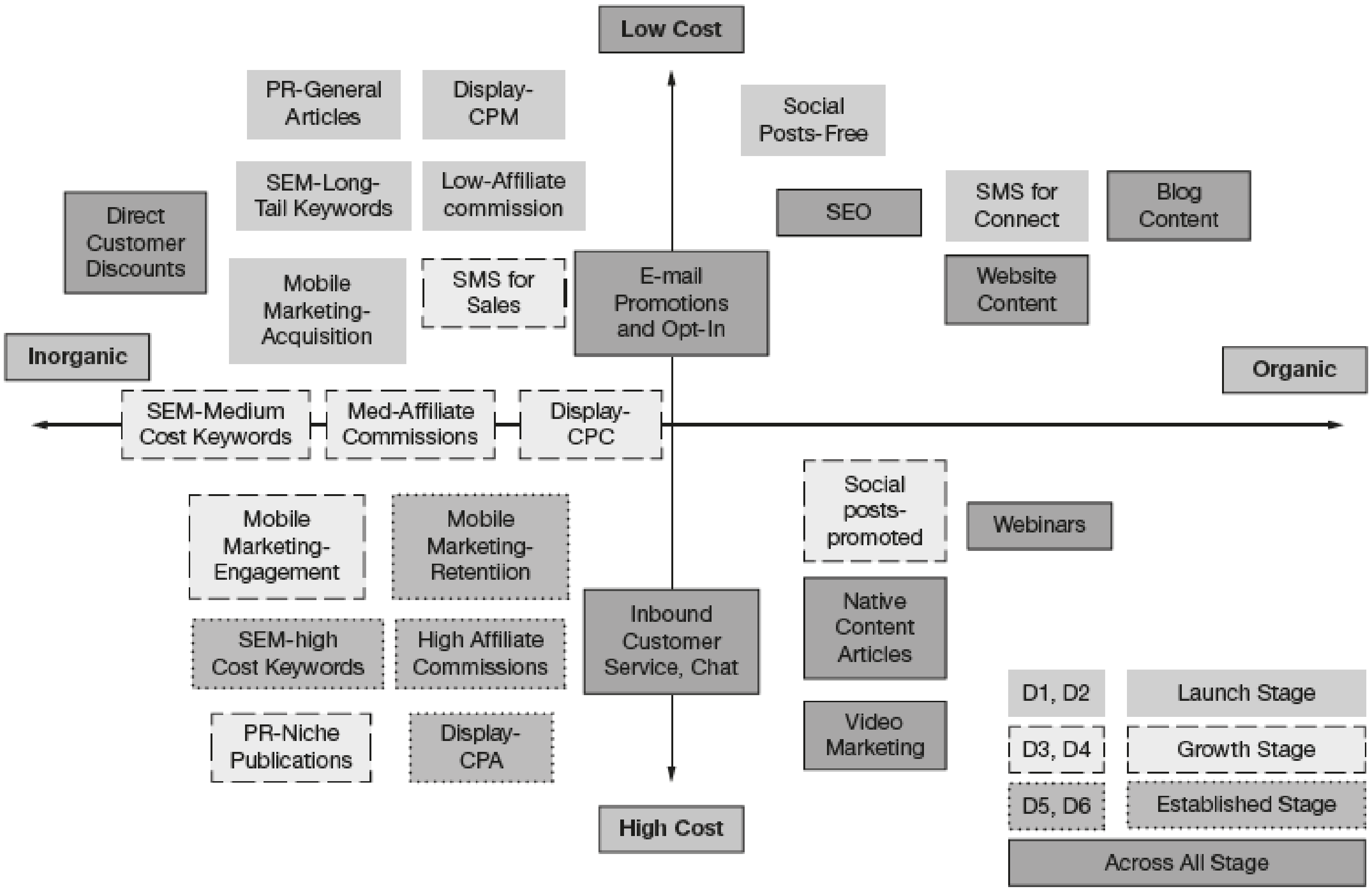
•**Monetary Investment** (e.g., paid ads, sponsorships, influencer collaborations)
•**Time & Effort Investment** (e.g., organic social media, SEO, content marketing)
•**Hybrid Investment** (e.g., webinars, events, partnerships that require both money and effort)

- To help firms (products) in each of the three group stages (launch, growth, and established) decide their channel mix, we have developed an easy-to-refer matrix—the ‘Digital Marketing Channel Mix Matrix’.

- In the matrix, the two key considerations discussed earlier ‘Promotion outcome type (organic/inorganic)’ and ‘Promotion investment type (low or lean/high cost)’ are placed across X and Y axis respectively.

- The varied promotional types and their respective channels are plotted, based upon the implementation stage most appropriate to them and the relative costs of spending on those channels.

Digital Marketing Channel Mix Matrix



Organic Marketing

In digital marketing, **organic** refers to marketing strategies that generate traffic, engagement, or conversions **without** direct paid promotions. These methods focus on **building long-term brand presence** and attracting audiences naturally.

Examples of Organic Marketing:

✅ **SEO (Search Engine Optimization)** – Ranking in Google search results without paying for ads.

✅ **Content Marketing** – Blogs, videos, and infographics that attract users naturally.

✅ **Social Media Engagement** – Posting, commenting, and interacting without running paid ads.

✅ **Word-of-Mouth & Referral Marketing** – People sharing your brand voluntarily.

✅ **Email Marketing (Non-Paid)** – Sending newsletters or drip campaigns to an audience you've built.

Since organic methods don't rely on direct ad spending, they often take **more time and effort** but can be **cost-effective** in the long run.

Inorganic Marketing

Inorganic Marketing (Paid Marketing)

Inorganic marketing refers to strategies that involve **direct paid promotions** to reach an audience quickly. These methods focus on **immediate visibility and conversions** by spending on advertising.

Examples of Inorganic Marketing:

✅ **PPC (Pay-Per-Click) Advertising** – Google Ads, Bing Ads, etc. (paid search results).

✅ **Paid Social Media Ads** – Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, and YouTube ads.

✅ **Influencer Marketing (Paid Collaborations)** – Paying influencers to promote products.

✅ **Sponsored Content** – Paying media sites or blogs to feature your content.

✅ **Affiliate Marketing (Performance-Based Ads)** – Paying commissions for sales or leads.

💡 **Key Difference:** Inorganic methods **deliver faster results** but require **continuous spending**. Once you stop paying, the traffic usually drops.

Type	Low Cost Channels	High Cost Channels
Organic	✅ Social Media Engagement (posts, community interaction)	✅ High-Quality SEO (hiring agencies, premium tools)
	✅ Basic SEO (on-page optimization, free tools)	✅ High-Production Content Marketing (professional videos, blogs)
	✅ Word-of-Mouth & Referral Marketing	✅ Influencer Partnerships (long-term collaborations)
	✅ Email Marketing (to an existing list)	✅ Podcasting (if high-end production is needed)
Inorganic	✅ Low-Budget PPC Campaigns (long-tail keywords)	✅ Google PPC Ads (competitive high-CPC keywords)
	✅ Affiliate Marketing (pay-per-conversion)	✅ Paid Social Media Ads (Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, YouTube)
	✅ Retargeting Ads (small daily budget)	✅ Sponsored Content & Paid PR
	✅ Micro-Influencer Marketing (small budgets)	✅ Celebrity & Macro-Influencer Marketing

Allocate Budget across Channel Mix

The four methods most commonly used for communication budget allocation include (from Philip Kotler, Marketing Management 14th edition):

(a) **Affordable method:** Communication budget is set depending upon what the firm thinks it can afford. This method looks at promotions as a cost and not an investment and makes long-range planning difficult for marketers.

(b) **Percentage of sales method:** Communication expenditures are set as a specified percentage of current or anticipated sales. Its disadvantage is that it again views sales as a determiner of communications rather than vice versa and ignores market opportunities and aggressive promotions as impact factors for sales.

(c) **Competitive parity method:** Setting communication budget in comparison to competitive budgets on similar products. The disadvantage is that competitor's budget factors, resources, and constraints might not be similar to the firm and this might not be the best way of assessing promotional budgets.

(d) **Objective and task method:** Here marketers develop communication budgets by defining specific objectives, determining the tasks for executing those objectives, and estimating the costs of performing those tasks. The sum of all these costs is taken as communication budget. The advantage that this method has over others is that it involves managers taking a clear view of their objectives and laying forth proper grounds for a calculated approach to budgets, taking into consideration all the assumptions, thus, making it more scientific.

Aspect	Organic Marketing	Inorganic Marketing
Definition	Marketing strategies that generate traffic and leads naturally over time without paid promotions.	Marketing strategies that involve paid advertisements to reach a wider audience quickly.
Examples	SEO, content marketing, social media posts, email newsletters, word-of-mouth.	PPC ads (Google Ads, Facebook Ads), influencer marketing, paid sponsorships, display ads.
Cost	Low-cost or free but requires time and effort.	Requires a budget for ads, influencers, or sponsorships.
Time to Results	Long-term (months or years).	Short-term (immediate results).
Sustainability	Sustainable with consistent efforts.	Results stop when ad spending stops.
Trust & Credibility	Builds high trust and credibility over time.	May be seen as promotional; less trust initially.
Audience Targeting	Organic reach depends on engagement and algorithms.	Can be precisely targeted based on demographics, interests, and behavior.
Scalability	Slower but scalable with consistent content and engagement.	Easily scalable with increased budget.
Examples of Use Cases	Building brand authority, nurturing leads, long-term engagement.	Product launches, quick lead generation, seasonal promotions.

PR General articles: These articles focus on brand positioning, industry leadership, and reputation building rather than direct promotion.

SEM Long-Tail Keywords: Long-tail keywords in Search Engine Marketing (SEM) are highly specific, longer search phrases (usually 3+ words) that target niche audiences. These keywords have lower competition and higher conversion rates compared to short, broad keywords.

Ex.

Short-Tail Keyword	Long-Tail Keyword
"Running shoes"	"Best running shoes for flat feet under ₹5000"
"Digital marketing"	"Best digital marketing courses for beginners in India"
"Laptops"	"Affordable gaming laptops with RTX 4060 in 2024"

Mobile Marketing:

- ❖ Acquisition – Gaining new users or customers through mobile channels.
- ❖ Engagement – Keeping users actively interacting with the app or mobile content.
- ❖ Retention – Encouraging users to continue using the app and preventing churn.

SEM High cost keyword: In Search Engine Marketing (SEM), high-cost keywords are search terms with high CPC (Cost Per Click) due to strong competition among advertisers. These keywords are usually from industries with high customer value, such as finance, insurance, legal services, and real estate.

PR - Niche Publications - Niche Publications refers to getting featured in industry-specific media outlets, blogs, or magazines that cater to a specialized audience. Instead of general news media, niche publications focus on a specific field, such as technology, healthcare, fashion, or finance.

❖ **Display CPA (Cost Per Acquisition) :** Refers to a pricing model in display advertising where advertisers pay only when a specific action is completed, such as:

✓ A purchase (e-commerce)

✓ A sign-up (newsletter, webinar, free trial)

✓ An app install

✓ A lead form submissionUnlike CPM (Cost Per Mille) or CPC (Cost Per Click), where advertisers pay for impressions or clicks, CPA ensures payment only when a user completes the desired action, making it a performance-based model.

❖ **Native content articles** are paid articles that look and feel like regular website or blog content. Instead of directly advertising a product, they provide useful information while naturally mentioning a brand. For example, a travel website might publish an article like "Best Budget Travel Destinations" and subtly recommend a hotel or airline.

Owned Media – Channels a brand fully controls, like websites, blogs, and social media profiles.
Earned Media – Free publicity gained through word-of-mouth, PR mentions, social shares, and customer reviews.
Paid Media – Promotional content where brands pay for visibility, such as ads, sponsored posts, and influencer marketing.

Steps to creating marketing communications strategy

- Researching perceptions to present communication efforts
- Setting the overall communication/positioning objectives
- Identifying target audiences
- Detailed primary and secondary communication channels
- Developing the communication message/creative plan for each channel
- Executing the communication strategy through timed campaigns
- Evaluate and refine communication strategy on an ongoing basis

Researching perceptions to present communication efforts – Understand how your audience views your brand to shape effective messaging.

Setting the overall communication/positioning objectives – Define clear goals for brand messaging, like awareness, engagement, or sales.

Identifying target audiences – Determine who you want to reach based on demographics, behavior, and preferences.

Detailed primary and secondary communication channels – Choose the best platforms (social media, email, ads, PR) for reaching your audience.

Developing the communication message/creative plan for each channel – Craft tailored messages and visuals for each platform.

Executing the communication strategy through timed campaigns – Launch campaigns strategically, ensuring the right message reaches the right audience at the right time.

Evaluate and refine communication strategy on an ongoing basis – Monitor performance, analyze results, and adjust strategies for better impact.

1. Researching perceptions to present communication efforts

this stage involves marketers researching and analyzing present consumer perceptions to their brands and the company's portfolio of products at large. Key steps include:

- Identifying research objectives relative to a specific advertising and marketing communications strategy
- Compiling, comparing, and evaluating the results of quantitative/qualitative research findings relative to specific marketing communications
- Selecting a relevant sampling technique and sample size to be analyzed
- Gathering qualitative and quantitative data in a variety of ways relative to the communications objective (e.g., conducting interviews, user survey software)
- Drawing valid conclusions from the analysis of data for development of an advertising and marketing communications plan

2. Setting the overall communication/positioning objectives

The purpose of any marketing communication is to inform the target audience about the company's specific objectives like,

- new product launch
- attracting new segment
- getting present customer to buy more
- rebranding–improving image of a present product

Typical objective areas are

Awareness – Inform customers about a new or updated product to generate interest.

Preference – Highlight unique benefits to make customers choose your product over competitors.

Trial and Repeat Purchase – Encourage first-time buyers and motivate them to keep purchasing.

After Image – Strengthen the brand’s reputation in customers' minds after they have bought the product.

Frequency and Variety of Use – Drive repeat website visits and promote cross-category purchases.

Promotional Incentives – Offer discounts, deals, or rewards to encourage more frequent buying

3. Identifying target audiences

- Capture Attention – The main goal is to grab the interest of the right people.
- Market Segmentation – Divide the audience into groups based on common characteristics like age, ocation, or interests.
- Define & Analyze – Understand the needs, behaviors, and preferences of each group.
- Select Consumer Profiles – Choose the most relevant audience segments to focus your communication on.

- Target audiences should be divided into three key categories—**consumer**, **customer**, and **influencer**, and messages specific to each group should be created. Consumers are those who finally consume/use the product, customers are the ones who buy the product and might not necessarily use them, while influencers are the group which influence a purchase but might neither buy nor use the product.

Consumers – The people who actually use the product.
Example: A child drinking a juice box is the consumer because they are the one using the product.

Customers – The buyers who purchase the product but may not use it themselves.
Example: A parent buying the juice box for their child is the customer because they made the purchase.

Influencers – People who influence the purchase decision but may not buy or use the product.
Example: A school teacher recommending a healthy juice brand to parents is an influencer, as they guide the purchase decision but don’t buy or consume the product.

4. Detailed primary and secondary communication channels

- involves the process of selecting the right media channels to deploy for communication and outlining the mix of integrated traditional and digital channels

- through the application of Digital Marketing Channel Mix Matrix, we have covered in detail the process of evaluation and selection of key communication channels which are being deployed these days for implementation across launch, growth, and established stages.

- Companies in this stage also need to decide on the channels which would be primary for them and the ones which are secondary based on budget availability and communication priorities.

5. Developing the communication message/creative plan for each channel

- involves the steps and techniques towards developing the message which would be communicated across multiple chosen channels.

- Decisions on what aspects to communicate and the way of communication (similar or different from competition) are taken in this stage.

- Developing communications message involves taking decisions on four key areas—

(a) Message content: What to say?
(b) Message structure: How to say it logically?
(c) Message format: How the message will be shared?
(d) Message source: Who would say it?

With examples:

1. **Message Content – What to Say?**
    1. Decide the main idea or information you want to convey.
    2. **Example:** A skincare brand may focus on "100% natural ingredients for glowing skin."
2. **Message Structure – How to Say It Logically?**
    1. Arrange the content in a persuasive and clear way.
    2. **Example:** A car brand may structure the message like this:
        1. **Problem:** High fuel costs?
        2. **Solution:** Our car gives the best mileage in its class.
        3. **Proof:** Tested and certified for 20 km/l mileage.
3. **Message Format – How the Message Will Be Shared?**
    1. Choose the format (video, text, images, infographics, etc.).
    2. **Example:** A fast-food chain may use short, engaging video ads on Instagram, while a B2B company may prefer a blog post or webinar.
4. **Message Source – Who Would Say It?**
    1. Select the best spokesperson (brand ambassador, influencer, CEO, or customer testimonial).
    2. **Example:** A fitness brand may have a famous athlete endorse their protein supplements.

6. Executing the communication strategy through timed campaigns

involves setting up structured campaigns that determine the optimal time to reach the target segment, the frequency and duration of the campaigns, and the budget allocation for each channel.

Above the Line (ATL) Media – Mass media that reaches a large audience but has limited direct feedback.
Example: TV, radio, newspapers, and magazines.
Used for: Brand awareness and reaching a wide audience quickly.

Below the Line (BTL) Media – More personal communication with direct feedback but a smaller audience.
Example: Conferences, brochures, pamphlets, and special events.
Used for: Building relationships and engaging specific groups.

Through the Line (TTL) Media – A mix of both, where messages reach a large audience and direct feedback is possible.
Example: The internet (social media, websites, email marketing).
Used for: Digital marketing where businesses can interact directly with customers.

7. Evaluate and refine communication strategy on an ongoing basis

This step ensures that marketing efforts are effective and continuously improved.

Key Steps:

Measure Effectiveness – Use tools to track how well marketing campaigns are performing.

Analyze Data – Review numbers (sales, clicks) and feedback (customer opinions) to understand impact.

Make Improvements – Adjust strategies based on results to improve future campaigns.This helps businesses optimize their marketing for better results.

Introduction to Digital Marketing Channels

- Intent-based marketing
- Brand marketing
- Community-based marketing

Intent-based marketing - Search Marketing

- **Intent-based marketing** is a strategy that focuses on understanding and targeting customers based on their intent or purpose behind searching for a product or service. This approach uses data from online searches, browsing behavior, and engagement patterns to deliver highly relevant marketing messages to potential customers at the right time.

For example, if a person searches for "best smartphones under ₹20,000," marketers can show ads or content related to budget-friendly smartphones, knowing that the customer intends to buy one soon.

- In traditional marketing, there was never a possibility to understand consumer's intent and be able to target them on their specific needs.
- The advent of search technology and specifically the arrival of Google, there was a sort of revolution, wherein marketers could know at a mass level, the intent of a particular set of customers through the keywords they typed in a search bar and be able to bid against those keywords to place their ads in front of those who had shared that intent.

- This is the most powerful way for marketers to know the keywords related to their specific industry, product, geographical region, and be able to choose the ones which matter, to target customers in their buying cycle (researching a product or trying to satisfy a present or a future need).

- *Search engine marketing,* by definition, involves marketing to internet users through natural search engine result page listings and paid advertisement placement next to the search results.

In simplest terms, any form of search engine marketing involves:

(a) A user typing any combinations of words **(known as keywords in search terminology)**
(b) into an input space **(called a search-box)**
(c) through usage of search technologies **(crawling and indexing)**, and
(d) application of complex programs **(known as search algorithms)**
(e) delivering the best matched weblinks **(known as Organic Search results)** and
(f) displaying paid weblinks **(known as Pay Per Click)**

In the above definition (related to point 'e'), the process by which any specific website, blog, portal, etc., applies efforts and techniques to optimize its content to be matched to a specific keyword searched is known as Search Engine Optimization (SEO).

On the other side (related to point 'f'), the structured set of marketing programs run by the specific search engine to put a price to a specific set of keywords and sell them to multiple businesses (web-marketers) is known as Search Engine Marketing (SEM) or Paid Per Click Marketing (PPC).

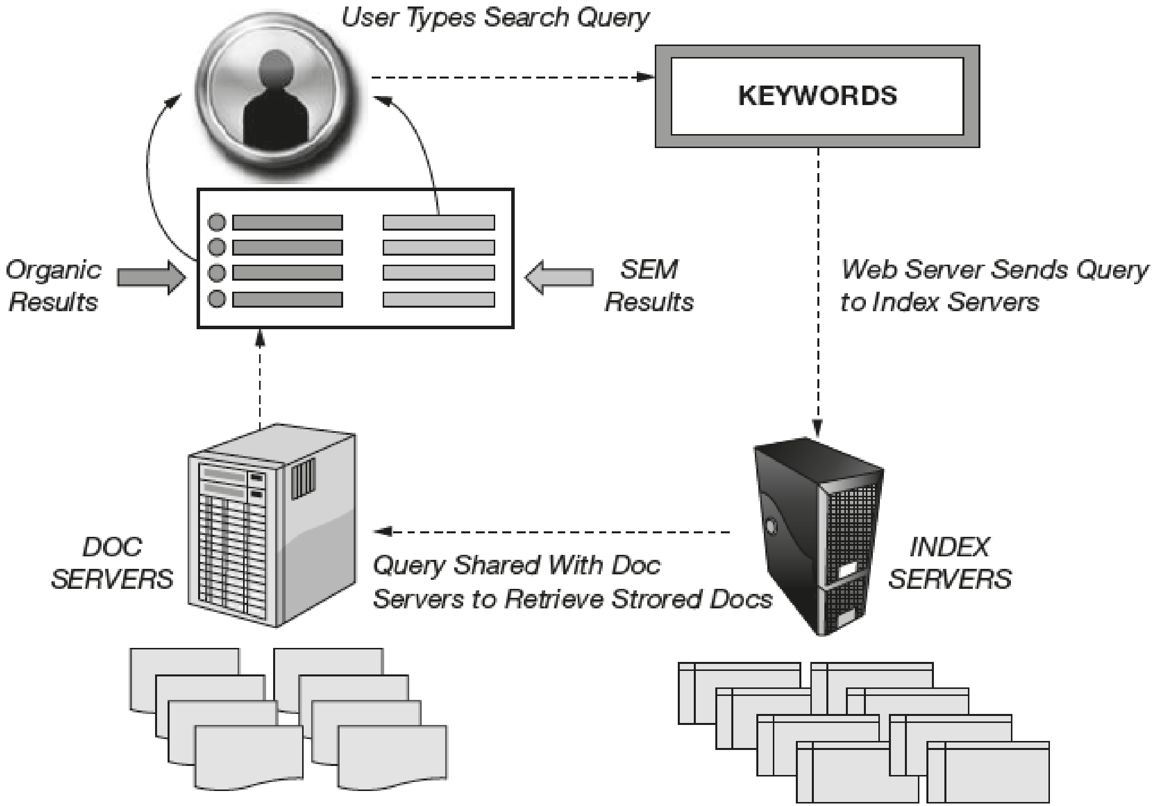
Crawling: The process where search engine bots scan web pages.

Indexing: The process of storing and organizing crawled pages in a search engine’s database.

A **spider** (also called a **crawler** or **bot**) is a program used by search engines to discover, scan, and collect information from web pages.

"snippets" refer to the short descriptions or summaries of web pages that appear in search engine results. These snippets provide users with a preview of the page content before they click on the link.

Working of Search Engines



In Fig. 6.11, we have showcased the working of any frontline search engine which involves the following steps:

(a) The user shows his/her intent by typing a search query in any combination of words which in Search Terminology are known as 'keywords'.

(b) Once the web server receives the query, it sends the query to the index server where web pages are indexed. A typical search engine's job is to keep crawling the web regularly using software called 'spiders' which index content and save them in the index server for future use.

(c) When the user puts the query, the index server matches the most relevant pages with the help of document servers by ranking the ones which are most authoritative and have the best quality. In this stage, snippets are also generated to describe each search result to the user.

(d) Once the top results are ready to be served, they are showcased in two ways—organic results for which the website/brand does not have to pay for (Search Engine Optimized-SEO results) and those which the brand pays for visibility and which appear in the right corner and top of organic ads (which are known as search engine marketed SEM results). To make a search result appear organically, website owners have to develop the most authentic content on their owned channels (websites), at times having to look at even 200+ parameters.

Brand-Based Marketing (Display Marketing)

- The next widely deployed digital marketing channel is display marketing which takes along with it all forms of online advertising (be it across web, mobile or other emerging platforms like kiosk, surface, etc.) and is executed through graphical digital images similar to billboards, newspaper ads, and television ads. A display ad is typically embedded into a webpage and placed alongside content which is most related to the brand being advertised. We label this form of marketing as brand-based marketing, as the key objective here is to build the imagery of a brand and its elements (though it can also be used to generate leads and drive purchase through allied promotional messages).

- The key elements which help develop this brand imagery (and differentiate this form of marketing from text based marketing like SEM) includes images, animation, sound, video, etc., embedded in the ad and with the development of rich media and dynamic ads (which are more graphical and interactive in nature), there is practically no limit to the kind of creativity and formats which can be generated to capture a visitor’s attention to a display ad.

Community-Based Marketing (Social Media Marketing)

- The third most important type of digital marketing channel relates to utilizing consumer's need of community interaction which is the most basic of human activities. This form of marketing relates to concepts like word of mouth, influence building, networking, viralty, personal communication, etc. We term this as community-based marketing, also widely known as social media marketing.

- Definition of Social Media Marketing : - Social media is defined as the way people interact and communicate online utilizing platforms developed specifically for community-based networking. It refers to the process of gaining traffic or attention through social media sites.

Advantages of Social Media Marketing

Social media marketing’s unique advantages include:
(a) Best channel to develop user following: Social media with its networking effects provides the best opportunity to develop influencers and through them build user following.

(b) The humanizing effect: Social media is one of the few channels which help brands increase engagement by being more humanized across all their interactions.

(c) Best channel to begin with a lean budget: This channel requires minimum upfront investment to begin with and helps create an audience of thousands on a really lean budget.

(d) Improved customer insights: With listening tools being deployed extensively, social media helps understand what consumers are interested in and how they behave and react to marketing.